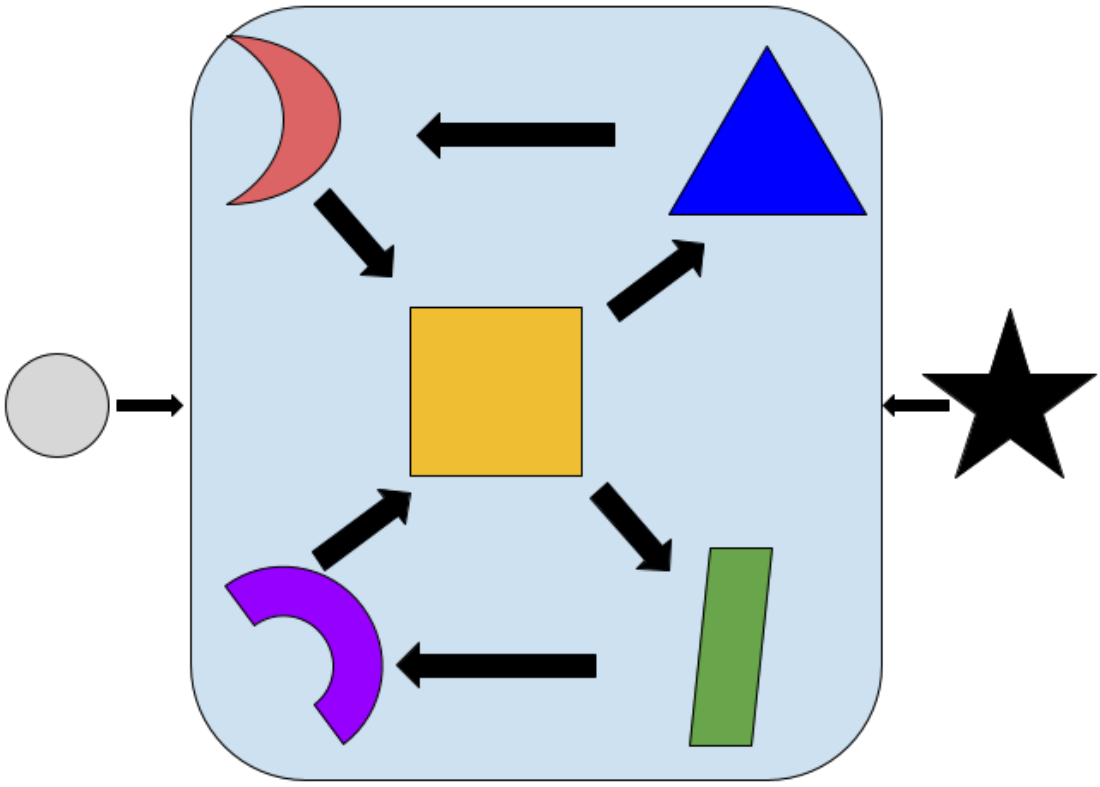
Important Stuff

Share Link : https://docs.google.com/document/d/115FmbYLIMP0FA9nMBulWSDCw3ZXKYbXfbUgqfiVVGlE/edit?usp=sharing to see updated version just in case.

I probably will use this system in the future.

Skills

Turn based combat where special skills (i.e not the attack button) are locked behind combo fighter style combo chain. Every attack will increase your momentum, locking some skills and unlocking others. There are 7 types of skills, Basic (White), Slashes (Red), Thrusts (Blue), Parries (Yellow), Hooks (Purple), Swipes (Green), Finishers (Black). Each individual skill will lead into other types of skills (so for example a Slashing Skill called Straight Slash, may lead into Parries, Swipes, and Finishers)



They will usually feed in this order, with Basics not being fed by anything and finishers not feeding into anything. Generally the more flexible (I.e the more things a specific skills feeds into) the weaker the skill. And also the more a skill deviates from this order, the weaker it should be.

On top of that each type of skills has an identity

- Basic- The most fundamental skill type, is not fed into, will feed into something (maybe you only get one, determined by sword or by equip). The “Attack” button.
- Slash- The most average, increases momentum the most
- Thrust- The most damage, most susceptible to being blocked, doesnt increase momentum much
- Parry- The least damage, blocks, increases momentum the least (possibly even reducing it)
- Hooks- The least susceptible to being to blocked, the most common to “move into”
- Swipes-The trickiest, the second to least damage

- Finisher- The most flashy, doesn't lead into anything, so they end your combo

In other words for the 5 main types we have a scale of damage <-> utility going

Thrust <-> Slash <-> Hooks <-> Swipes <-> Parry

This makes one side of the right loop dedicated to damage and speed and the other dedicated to more control.

Momentum

Momentum is generated by using skills, and reset when the combo is broken (either because a basic attack was used, you were stalled, you couldn't continue the combo, etc.). Skills only work when you have a certain range of momentum (So a Slow Thrust, that combos into, Slashes, Hooks, and Finishers may only be available during momentum 0-20). In general momentum will unlock more powerful, but harder to use skills. (There should be a higher cost to flexibility at higher momentum). Generally finishers should be flat out stronger as momentum increases. Momentum should also be limited (or the maximum should be subtracted, by weapons and armors. Going over momentum should therefore immediately end the combo.

Firstly, this gives a little progression locks. As players unlocked skills in higher and higher momentums they can keep their combos going longer and longer.

Secondly, this can add challenge and technique which can be mastered. By making chains harder to keep going at higher momentums, it makes keeping (useful) long chains a bit more of a skill.

Thirdly, it encourages build variety. Maybe you have a build that stays in a medium amount of momentum for a long time. Or a build that tries to repeatedly max momentum to deliver the strongest finishers. Or a build with short momentum bursts, encouraging flexibility. Or a beginner build where momentum doesn't matter, using weaker skills with large momentum bands.

Fourth, this gives another level to balance skills. On top of power, utility, flexibility, uniformity (how well it conforms to the type of skill it is), we also have momentum range and momentum gain.

Momentum Bands

Momentum maxes out at 100. The maximum can be lowered by different equipped items.

Enemies and Combat

Combat should be classically turn-based. Generally it should be a one person party (so one-on-one combat should be the norm). Big attacks should be telegraphed, giving players enough time to try to rotate to a defensive skills. Elemental weakness can exist. Enemies should also rotate through stances that have weaknesses or resistances to different skill types. This

means that on top of Elemental affinities, which remain generally static, there are also stances and forms to consider when rotating through skills.

Items

In general two equip slots, one for a hand item and one for an armor. In general higher defense should limit momentum more.

Your item controls which basic skill you use

Broadsword for Slashes

Rapier for Thrusts

Greatsword for Parry

Shortsword for Hooks

Longsword for Swipes

Possible things

Mechanics

- Different weapons other than swords or dual wielding.
    - Different weapons can only use a limited amount of skills (I.e spears can only use Slashes, Thrusts, and Swipes. Axes can only used Slashes, Parries, and Hooks) but they give bonus effects. Fists that can't slash, and finishers. Daggers shouldn't be able to Swipe or Parry.
        - Spears (Slashes, Thrusts, and Swipes) can have a playstyle with limited combo potential, but can deal big damage (fast momentum into relatively small finishers type style).
            - Should generally go Thrust -> Slash -> Swipe -> Finisher. Three step combo is pretty good. If we want to extend (for more momentum or timing), Slash has a Stalling Slash.
            - Can have some swipes leading to thrusts at low momentum.
        - Axes (Slashes, Parries, and Hooks) should be about dealing big damage in short combos, with strong base attack and higher power skills. Allows for a good amount of defense.
            - Can use counter finisher to deal extra damage on parry or use parry as defense
            - Slash -> Parry -> Finisher or Hook -> Parry -> Finisher
            - Can use Stalling Slash or a hook -> slash move to build momentum

                - Slash -> Parry should be for quick finishers, and Hook -> Parry for longer combos.
            - Fists (Thrusts, Parries, Hooks,and Swipes) should be a slow building flexible build, taking time to gain momentum.
                - Fists can have special skills that reduce their momentum the most
                - In other words infinite combo should exist for fist, and should be rewarded for high combo potential
                - Can be cost benefit to using powerful fist skills that reduce momentum
                - Fist weapons can reduce momentum gained too.
        - Shields can allow the use of (certain) parries (will break your combo)
        - Dual wielding
            - If basic attacks are tied to weapons, dual wielding allows you to choose between the two basic attacks
            - Can increase momentum
            - Switches which sword hits (and their respective boosts)
            - Generally limits max momentum (buy virtue of holding more items)
- Armor or items that don't allow for martial skills, maker certain skills martial skills that can only be used with certain (weaker) armor
- To limit power,
    - there can be a point cost to i skills, which you increase either as a stat or is determined by your items.
    - There can be a limit to your skills equipped which increases as the game progresses
    - Maybe you can't use a skill twice in the same chain?

Items/builds

- Hyper Momentum- Sword that adds extra momentum per swipe, armor that grants chance to dodge?
- Midrange build
    - Skills that reduce momentum slightly
    - A lot of options for skills
- Low momentum/armor
    - Heavy armor
    - Strong weapon
    - Uses basic skills and a variety of skills to deal more direct damage and rebuffs
- Skill Ideas
    - Slash
        - that "stalls" or leads into another Slash
        - Speedy Slash - increases momentum by 15, does minimal damage, moves only into swipes (harder to go into a block, and repeat slashes for momentum building)
    - Thrust

        - That goes into swipes and hooks
    - Parry
        - That lowers momentum (should do basically nothing) in the midrange (above 30)
        - A move that takes all damage, but as a finisher lets it doll it out. (Counter Charge)
    - Hooks
        - That goes into a Slash (for axes)
    - Swipe
        - that disarms
        - that blocks some damage
        - Swipe that goes into a thrust at low momentum (spears are better for this)

Skills from 0-30 momentum

Basics that lead to every main type